their scientific studies to live in harmony with the natural world rather than attempt to dominate it. Elsewhere, this was not a new thought. Many indigenous peoples and religions, such as Hinduism, had advocated for or lived in harmony with nature for generations.

Arcadian ideology

In 1789, rural parson and naturalist Gilbert White published his *Natural History and Antiquities of Selborne*, which became a seminal work in what was later called "Arcadian Ecology". Educated at Oxford and a keen gardener and ornithologist, White closely observed the wildlife of his village, making meticulous notes from 1751 onward. Compiled from his correspondence about his findings with several like-minded naturalists, the book was more than simply a collection of data. White's engaging and often poetic style sent a persuasive message; his work rejected the "imperial" idea of conquering nature, and instead encouraged a balance between humans and the natural world—like that of the Ancient Greeks' mythical idyll of Arcadia, for which White's approach was named.

"From reading White's *Selborne* I took much pleasure in watching the habits of birds, and even made notes."

Charles Darwin

See also: Romanticism, conservation, and ecology • Environmental ethics • Indigenous peoples and local communities

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